



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	11/11/2022	Time of Incident:	09:45
Region / Directorate:	RMO – MW/G	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	SHW Incident - Health	EQSafe Incident Number:	29007
Actual Consequence:	Minor	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Worker Covered in Quicklime
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Executive Summary:

On November 11 at 09:45, a worker was assigned the task of clearing a quicklime blockage within the delivery line of a mobile bulk tanker. Steel delivery pipe flanges were separated, and approximately 250kg - 350kg of quicklime was dispersed onto the ground and surrounding area.

The Operator opened the dump valve and stored air pressure released onto the dispersed quicklime, billowing quicklime around the Operator. The Operator was heavily covered with quicklime.

The worker ceased the task and attempted to provide self-treatment at a nearby toilet facility. A worker in the area provided additional assistance to decontaminate the worker. There was no safety shower on site – the worker was taken to a local service station to use the showering facilities. The worker presented to Joondalup Health Campus for precautionary assessment – no further treatment was required.

Incident Photos:



Quicklime released under tanker.

Contributing Factors:

- **Awareness - Hazard Identification:** The Operator did not undertake a personal risk assessment prior to commencing the task and failed to control stored energy.
- **Awareness – Competence Knowledge:** The Operator is not competent in maintenance of pressure vessels.
- **Procedure Awareness:** The Sub-contractor system of work approved by the Principal Contractor did not define or detail the maintenance tasks. CRAW did not cover Maintenance work or change to the use of Quiklime from hydrated lime.
- **Protection and containment – PPE:** The Sub contractor failed to issue the Operator PPE for potential exposure hazards to quicklime.
- **Protection and Containment – Barricading and Exclusion Zones:** The Sub-contractor did not establish exclusion barriers for the quicklime storage and transfer area as required by their procedures and the Principal Contractor did not implement the inspection program for the quicklime storage and transfer area prior to the commencement of work.
- **Escape and Rescue – Emergency Planning:** The Principal Contractor and Sub-contractor did not evaluate and or establish the specific critical controls to be in place prior to establishment of storage and transfer area or consider the additional activities involved with the infrastructure.

Corrective Actions:

- Develop daily tracking register for KPI's including personal risk assessments; verify during tasks that they're being completed & deliver these finding through dashboards on a weekly and monthly basis to the project team and workforce.
- Review TNA against sub-contractor Position Descriptions and detail Maintenance Skill Set to perform repairs on pressure vessels / energised system.
- The Principal Contractor to develop and distribute a sub-contractor mobilisation management process to all sub-contractors to ensure that work processes are adequately assessed prior to commencement of any subcontractor activity – This includes review of the project CRAW.
- Complete audit on subcontractor – Ensure PPE is available to workers relevant to the scope of works.
- Relocate bulk tanker to a suitable area: Prior to operation, conduct a compliance audit on the system of work for the handling, storage, and emergency management.
- Complete Hazardous Substances audit to ensure that emergency response procedures and resources are in place in accordance with the subcontractor's revised work methodology.

Additional Issues/Learnings:

- What defines specialist Maintenance work appears poorly defined and understood. What can an Operator do as operational maintenance and at what point is a fitter or other specialist required should be explored and included in risk assessments & VOCs.



Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Critical Risk:
Hazardous Substances.

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations